

about implementing some adoption benefits! It may just take someone speaking up to get the ball rolling.

Transportation. Paid.

As an employee, you can receive transportation fringe benefits. Taking advantage of these benefits can lead to big savings. Every single month, you may be eligible to receive \$110 for transportation costs, or \$215 for parking costs! The money is yours tax free, and at the end of the year, you'll have more in your pockets. To get more information on this Qualification Transportation Fringe Benefit, go to www.irs.gov/publications/p15b/ar02.html#d0e2081. Once you've checked that out, talk to your employer to find out how you can start receiving these benefits.

Health Insurance. Paid.

Health insurance can be costly; that is why more and more people are opting to go without it. But it doesn't have to be that way. Why endure the risk of being left unprotected in the face of some unforeseen emergency that could, in the end, wipe you out completely? If you're over the age of 65, then there is no getting around the fact that you need a health insurance program that you can rely on. And if you're one of the many people who struggle to pay for Medicare coverage, I've got some great news for you...

Qualified Medicare Beneficiary (QMB) is a program aimed toward easing the burden of Medicare payments, and it's simple to apply for. If you qualify, the benefits are hefty; payments toward Medicare Part A and Medicare Part B, along with co-insurance and deductibles, can take the pressure off your pocketbook.

If you apply as an individual, your monthly income cannot exceed \$837, and for couples, you can't go past the \$1120 mark. Also, as an individual, your assets can't total up to more than \$4000; for a couple, it's \$6000. But don't worry – QMB doesn't count things like your home or car. Not only that, there are some states out there that don't set any limits on assets.

You can get in touch with Medicare by calling 1-800-MEDICARE (1-800-633-4227). Or simply visit their site at www.medicare.gov.